recognize that the Chinese had other specific objectives in mind. Unlike the Chinese leadership, there was little introspection, consultation or strategizing within the Indian political leadership. The workings of the two governments in the first twenty days of January 1950 would show that while one of them, China, was engaged in constant consultation and adjustment of tactics, the other, India, neither consulted nor felt the need to test presumptions against the responses they received from China. It reflected internal weakness in the governance of Indian foreign policy and lack of experience in international negotiation.

When Sen arrived in Beijing on 13 February it became immediately apparent that for China, the negotiations were not simply procedural or of the nature of protocol. Vice Minister Zhang Hanfu posed two substantive questions to Sen and insisted that the Government of India would need to clarify both matters before China even discussed the establishment of relations. The two Chinese questions were: first, whether India was ready to completely break off all contact with the KMT, including the remnants in India, and to transfer complete ownership of all KMT assets and funds in India to the People's Republic of China?; and second, whether India unambiguously upheld the People's Republic of China's membership in the United Nations and all its bodies, by virtue of them being the sole representative of the Chinese people? These were fresh demands; they went beyond the preconditions that China had conveyed to foreign countries on the question of diplomatic relations. The Chinese side also mounted pressure by complaining to Sen that India's abstention on a resolution moved by the Soviet Union in the Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC) on 7 February 1950 showed that India still continued to recognize the legitimacy of the representatives of the old Nationalist regime in the UN. The resolution sought to remove